

Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3 (15IAH7)

The ideal budget gaming laptop?

In this review, we're going to be taking a deeper look at the Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3 15IAH7, which comes with a 12th gen Intel Core i5 12450H, paired with an NVIDIA RTX 3050 Ti GPU. For the purposes of this review, we're going to be comparing it with... another Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3! The 15ACH6 variant to be exact, which features the AMD Ryzen 7 5800H processor paired with an NVIDIA RTX 3050. With that said, let's dive in!

BUILD AND DESIGN

Starting with this generation, the IdeaPad Gaming 3 has seen a bit of a design change. While the Ryzen variant still features the old design, the new Intel variant uses a design that's inspired by Lenovo's premium Legion gaming lineup. While the Legion lineup features a metal build, with the IdeaPad Gaming 3 you get a polycarbonate plastic build. The new hinge does feel slightly less secure than the old design, so the display flexes more comparatively, but not to a degree where we were really bothered by it. Coming to the keyboard, Lenovo laptops have always featured good keyboards as far as their laptops are concerned, and that still stands. Both the Intel and AMD variants come with full-sized keyboards with 100 percent anti-ghosting and 4-zone RGB lighting. The trackpad is alright as well, and doesn't get in the way while typing. It can always be disabled if you're using a mouse. The overall experience with the keyboard is good, with decent travel and feedback.

I/O

Coming to I/O options, they cover most of your needs, and are in-line with most



budget gaming laptop offerings in the market. It also one-ups the Ryzen model with the addition of a Thunderbolt 4 port, but once again, that's optional, so be sure to check before you make your IdeaPad Gaming 3 purchase. It is definitely worth having a Thunderbolt 4 port for its versatility.

DISPLAY

Being the budget gaming laptop offering from Lenovo, the display on the Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3 is not as good as their higher-end offerings. That being said, the display on the IdeaPad Gaming 3 is still pretty good, with close to 99 percent sRGB coverage and a peak brightness of 326 nits. These are significantly better numbers than what we saw on the older, AMD Ryzen variant.

PERFORMANCE & GAMING

With that, we come to the performance section. For general productivity, we use the PCMark 10 Extended benchmark. In every benchmark, the 12th gen Intel Core i5-12450H beat the Ryzen 7 5800H. This trend continued in the Cinebench R23 benchmark as well. These benchmarks test only the processing power of these laptops. So in a straight-up CPU comparison, the 12th gen Intel variant wins. Next, we come

to the RAM, where you get almost double the speed from the newer 12th gen IdeaPad Gaming 3. The newer SSD on the 12th gen IdeaPad Gaming 3 is also faster. There is a pretty sizable difference in scores between the Intel and AMD variant of the IdeaPad Gaming 3 when it comes to the 3DMark benchmarks. Considering the price of each variant, that's a lot more bang for your buck from the Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3 15IAH7. Then we come to the real-world gaming benchmarks. Once again, in both the medium preset and high preset, the newer IdeaPad Gaming 3, featuring the 12th gen Intel Core i5, outperformed the AMD variant in every benchmark. The difference is especially noticeable in CPU-intensive titles in which have almost double the FPS in our benchmarks.

HEAT, THROTTLE AND NOISE

During our tests, the 15IAH7 or Intel variant of the IdeaPad Gaming 3 throttled more than the AMD variant. It also tends to heat up more and draw more power than the AMD variant of the IdeaPad Gaming 3. The overall temperature is still lower than what we've seen across budget gaming laptops that we've tested.

VERDICT

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—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: 12th Gen Intel Core i5-12450H | Display: 15.6-inch FHD IPS | 120 Hz Refresh Rate | Memory: 16GB RAM DDR4-3200 | Storage: 512GB SSD | Graphics: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3050 Ti 4GB GDDR6 Dedicated Graphics | Audio: 2x2W HD Stereo Speakers | Camera: HD 720p with E-camera Shutter | Keyboard: Full-size 4-Zone white Backlit | Ports: 2x USB-A 3.2 Gen 1 | 1x USB-C Thunderbolt 4 | 1x Headphone / microphone combo jack (3.5mm) | 1x HDMI 2.0 | 1x Ethernet (RJ-45)

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